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Historical Site Conditions

The Hudson Yards site has a layered industrial history. The area served as storage yards for the New York Central Railroad from the 19th century onward, defining the Far West Side as a zone of infrastructure and logistics that separated Midtown from the waterfront. The Javits Convention Center (1986) signaled an early attempt to reposition the area as a public destination. The 2005 rezoning of the Special Hudson Yards District, originally tied to NYC's failed 2012 Olympic bid, unlocked the site for large-scale mixed-use development. The 7 subway line extension to 34th Street–Hudson Yards, completed in 2015, was a critical infrastructure investment. Construction of the platform deck over active LIRR rail yards began in 2014, creating the artificial ground plane on which the current development stands. This engineered landscape is a defining condition of the site, the ground itself is a constructed artifact, a condition that resonates with the project's conceptual framework of mediated nature.

Key Considerations

- **19th–20th century:** New York Central Railroad yards, industrial logistics zone
- **1986:** Javits Convention Center opens, begins repositioning the Far West Side
- **2005:** Special Hudson Yards District rezoning adopted (linked to Olympic bid)
- **2015:** 7 line subway extension to 34th St–Hudson Yards station opens
- **2014–present:** platform deck over active LIRR rail yards, artificial ground plane

Hudson Yard
2004



Hudson Yard
2026

